the fit. The reversing case also offers something unusually personal: a surface for an engraving that need not be visible to everyone else.

Equally, smaller need not mean less substantial. Chopard's L.U.C 1860 houses an automatic movement with a gold micro-rotor and a 65-hour power reserve inside a 36.5mm steel case. Its salmon-coloured, hand-guilloché dial rewards a closer look. Here is a useful reminder that serious watchmaking need not announce itself through a large case or a crowded display. I find this kind of discretion particularly attractive; there is enough to discover without having to explain the watch across a dinner table.

There should also be room for technical curiosity. Another fun favourite is the Grand Seiko's SLGW003, which pairs a manually wound, high-frequency movement with an 80-hour power reserve. Its titanium case adds another dimension to the discussion about comfort.



Clockwise from left: Pharrell Williams wore a Richard Mille RM 74-02 Automatic Winding Tourbillon in gold quartz TPT and rose gold at the 68th Grammy Awards; collector David Young's treasury of timepieces; an illustration of Audemars Piguet's Royal Oak "Serena Williams" Limited Edition, displayed during its launch event earlier this year; Leonardo DiCaprio flaunted a discontinued Rolex Daytona "Le Mans" in 18-karat white gold at the 2026 BAFTAs